GFAM v6.5 cheat sheet

Drum synth for the Game Boy Advance · gestures, SYNTH, SEQ, FX

Global gestures

These work the same on all 6 tabs: SYNTH · PATCH · SEQ · KICK · PATT · FX.

L / R	Switch tab
← / →	Select the knob or the step
↑ / ↓	Turn the knob (hold = repeat). On pads and in PATT they move the cursor
A + ↑ / ↓	Fine adjust of the value (SYNTH, PATCH, SEQ, FX, kick knobs, STEP EDIT)
SELECT + ↑ / ↓	Trig condition of the step under the cursor (KICK pads and SEQ)
SELECT + ← / →	Jump to the next group of knobs
START + ↑ / ↓	Next / previous pattern, from any tab. If playing, it enters at the start of the next bar; it takes you out of the song
SELECT + L / R	Previous / next preset: the synth sound on SYNTH and SEQ, the kick sound on KICK (not in STEP EDIT). Steps and BPM untouched
START (tap)	RUN / STOP. Stopping also stops the song
SELECT (tap)	Opens OPTIONS: RESUME · HELP · RESTART APP
SELECT + B	BPM edit mode on / off: ↑ / ↓ ±1, ← / → ±10
SELECT + START	RND of what the tab shows: SYNTH the sound · PATCH 2–4 cables · SEQ the steps · KICK the pattern (on the pads) or the kick sound (on the knobs) · PATT everything. Never changes BPM or VOL

On the tabs where A combines with ↑ / ↓ (SYNTH, SEQ, PATCH, FX, the kick knobs and STEP EDIT), A acts when you let go of it, and does nothing if it was used for the fine adjust.

FX

A chain of five devices: compressor, stutter, delay, reverb and limiter (always last). They are global: they do not change with the pattern.

← / →	Select a device or a setting
↑ / ↓	Turn the value (on a lamp: switch the device on / off)
A + ↑ / ↓	Fine adjust
A (on release)	On a lamp: switch the device on / off

Every device has a lamp (ON) and MIX. AMT = compressor amount · SLC = stutter slice (16 / 32 / 64 / 128) · TIM = delay time (1/8, dotted 1/8, 1/4, dotted 1/4) · FBK = delay feedback · SIZ = reverb size · TON = reverb tone. Limiter: lamp + THR, a threshold from 0 to -10 dB in 0.1 dB steps (default -0.6 dB). The chain is CMP > STU > DLY > REV > LIM.

SYNTH

23 knobs in rows of 8: VCO 1 · VCO 2 · MOD · FILTER · ENVELOPES · OUTPUT. Waveforms are drawn as icons, switches as lamps.

← / →	Select the knob
↑ / ↓	Turn the knob (hold = repeat)
A + ↑ / ↓	Fine adjust
A (on release)	Plays the step: the note sounds
SELECT + ← / →	Jump to the next group of knobs
SELECT + START	RND of the sound (BPM and VOL untouched)

VCO waveforms: TRI · SQR · SAW · PLS (25 % pulse) · SIN · ORG (organ) · FLD (sine with auto-FM) · HOL (odd harmonics).

SEQ

The synth's 8 steps: a PITCH row and a VELOCITY row (0 = rest), and a conditional trig for each step. Lamps show the step that is playing.

← / →	Select the step
↑ / ↓	Turn the pitch or velocity knob
A + ↑ / ↓	Fine adjust
SELECT + ↑ / ↓	Change the step's condition (TRIG row); its number turns orange when it has one
SELECT + ← / →	Jump between the two rows
A (on release)	Plays the step
SELECT + START	RND of the steps

A "bar" is 16 steps, as in the kick, so the 8-step sequencer repeats twice per bar.

Trig conditions

A condition x:N plays the step only on bar x of every N bars; 1:1 = always. Change it with SELECT + ↑ / ↓ on the KICK pads and in SEQ (and as the last knob of STEP EDIT). A bar is 16 steps. The bar counter starts at 0 on RUN and when the pattern changes.

1	1:1
2	1:2 · 2:2
3	1:3 · 2:3 · 3:3
4	1:4 · 2:4 · 3:4 · 4:4
8	1:8 · 4:8 · 8:8
16	1:16 · 8:16 · 16:16

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KICK

16 big pads (off / trig / accent) and 8 knobs with the kick sound, which is global to the pattern. A pad's number turns orange when it has a condition or locks.

ON A PAD

← / → / ↑ / ↓	Move the cursor over the pads (on to the knobs after pad 16)
A	Toggles the trig, at once
SELECT + A	Accent
SELECT + ↑ / ↓	Change the trig condition (TRIG row)
B	Enters STEP EDIT for that step
SELECT + START	RND of the pattern or of the kick sound

ON THE KICK KNOBS

↑ / ↓	Turn the knob
A + ↑ / ↓	Fine adjust
B or A (on release)	Hear the kick
SELECT + L / R	Kick preset

The 8 knobs: TUN tune · SWP pitch sweep · PDC pitch decay · ADC amplitude decay · CLK click · DRV drive · WAV waveform (SIN / TRI / FLD) · LVL level.

KICK: STEP EDIT (p-locks)

STEP nn LOCKS: the knobs become that step's own. Orange ones are locked, dim ones use the global sound. A step with locks does not change the global sound.

← / →	Select the knob (the last one is TRIG, the condition)
↑ / ↓	Turn the knob and lock it (with A = fine adjust)
A (on release)	Plays that step with its locks
SELECT + A	Removes the lock (or sets the condition back to every bar)
B	Back to the pads

What is saved, and presets

A pattern keeps the synth's 8 steps (pitch + velocity), the kick's 16, both sounds, the PATCH cables, and the kick's locks and conditions. BPM, VOL and the effects are global. Patterns and song are NOT saved when you power off: the factory state comes back (pattern 1 with the default synth steps, kick patterns 1–10 filled in, every pattern with the starting sound, empty song).

Synth	808 KICK · SEQ BASS · HATS · FM TOMS · MUSICBOX · ZAP SYNC
Kick	808 SUB · 909 PUNCH · TECHNO · HARD · DEEP SUB · ZAP KICK

PATCH

Plugs a source into each of the 8 inputs (jacks), with an amount per cable from -99 to 99 (negative inverts). A new cable starts at 50.

↑ / ↓	On a jack: pick its source
↑ / ↓	On the amount knob (bottom row): -99 … 99
A	Unplugs the cable (source OFF, amount 0)
A + ↑ / ↓	Fine adjust
SELECT + START	Plugs 2–4 random cables

INPUTS

VC1 · VC2	Pitch of VCO 1 and VCO 2
CUT	Filter cutoff
RES	Resonance
FM	FM amount
VCA	Level
DEC	The three decays at once
NSE	Noise level

SOURCES

SEQ	Pitch of the step
VEL	Velocity of the step
VCO · VCF · VCA	The three envelopes
NSE	Noise
KCK	Kick envelope
RND	A new random value on every step

DEC only hears SEQ, VEL and RND (applied when the note is triggered). Cables belong to the pattern's sound; a preset (SELECT + L / R) removes them. The SEQ knob on the SYNTH tab keeps working on its own.

PATT: patterns and song

32 patterns (4 rows × 8) and a 32-slot song (4 × 8). Green = playing, orange = queued next, dim = empty. Every pattern keeps its own sound.

← / → / ↑ / ↓	Move the cursor (at the end of a row it goes on to the next)
A on a pattern	Launches it (at the next bar if playing)
A on COPY / PASTE	Copy the current pattern, with sound, locks and conditions / paste it over the current one
A on CLEAR	Erases steps, locks and conditions; keeps the sound
A on RAND	Randomizes the current pattern
A on a song slot	Puts the current pattern in it
A + ↑ / ↓	Held on a song slot: changes its number (-- = empty, skipped)
A on PLAY	Plays the song from the first filled slot, in a loop; again to stop
START + ↑ / ↓	Next / previous pattern (from any tab)
SELECT + START	RND of the whole pattern, steps and sounds